

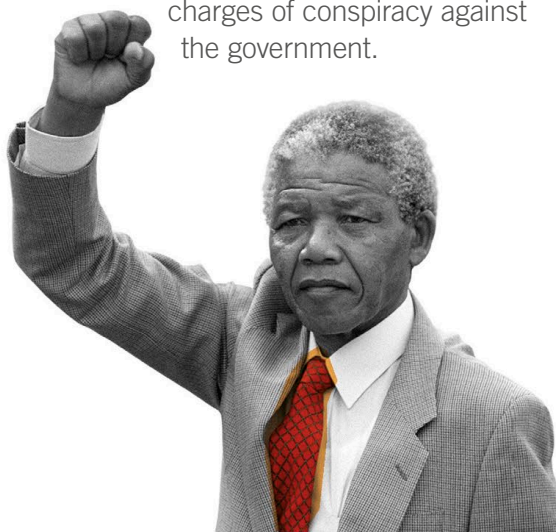
February

11

1990

Mandela freed

South African activist Nelson Mandela, who fought against apartheid (a system of racial discrimination), was released after 27 years in prison. He had been arrested on charges of conspiracy against the government.



2014

Olympic first

German Carina Vogt became the first-ever women's ski jumping champion when she won the gold medal at the Sochi Winter Olympics in Russia.



Born this day

1930 Barbara Mary Quant, British fashion designer. Her mini-skirts and hot pants became fashion necessities in the 1960s.

1972 Kelly Slater, US surfer. He won a record-breaking 11 world surfing championships.

660 BCE

National Foundation Day

According to tradition, Japan was founded on this day by Jimmu, the first Japanese emperor. This date is now celebrated every year in Japan as a public holiday, known as National Foundation Day.



Also on this day

1576 The king of Denmark gave Tycho Brahe the island of Hven, where the astronomer built his own observatory to study the skies.

1929 With the signing of the Lateran Treaty, the Vatican City in Rome became a country – the smallest in the world to this day.

2011 President Hosni Mubarak of Egypt resigned after 30 years in power, following protests against his rule across the country.